



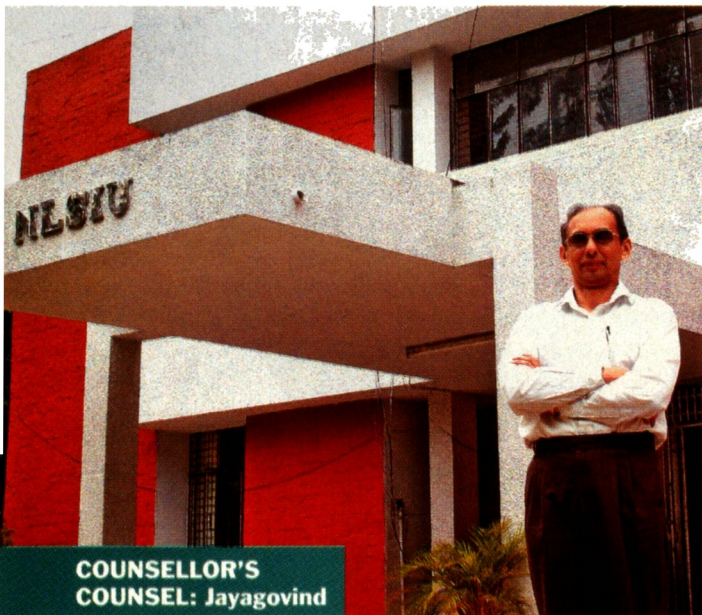
NATIONAL LAW SCHOOL OF INDIA UNIVERSITY, BANGALORE RAISING THE BAR

A. Jayagovind doesn't recall a particular moment that has been memorable for him in his five years as vice-chancellor of the National Law School of India University (NLSIU). Rather, "it has been full of challenges and I have coped with them to the best of my ability", he says. Jayagovind's achievement lies in spearheading an institution which started as an experiment, but has set the benchmark of the quality of law education in the country. In the 1970s, senior members of the Indian legal fraternity were debating whether the then standards of legal education were up to the mark. The debate came to an end with the establishment of the NLSIU in 1987. Started under the stewardship of N.R. Madhava Menon, its founder-director, it not only opened a whole new concept by integrating a graduate degree with a law degree, but raised the bar of legal education in the country. Today, it's the best example of academy-bar-bench cooperation in India. As NLSIU completes 20 years in its bid for an alternative and effective form of law education, it faces a new challenge. The very purpose for which NLSIU was started doesn't really hold good anymore, as most of its students opt for corporate jobs instead of litigation in courtrooms. It may be time for another debate.

by Swagata Sen

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COUNSELLOR'S
COUNSEL: Jayagovind

SANJAY RAMCHANDRAN



ELITE PANEL: D-School
founder V.K.R.V. Rao (centre)

DELHI SCHOOL OF ECONOMICS, DELHI THE THINK TANK

Off in one corner, over the rattle and banging of steel vessels on bright red plastic tables, a discussion is underway on the theory of sub-development. As steaming plates of vada sambhar, keema dosas and mince cutlets arrive, the focus shifts to reading lists for econometrics. Renovations may have given it a glass façade, but the canteen is still the hub at the Delhi School of Economics, universally known as D-School. It's where the brightest minds of the country spent hours debating everything from the poverty cycle to the economic fallouts of climate change. It's also the place where Nobel laureate Amartya Sen met his second wife, Eva Colorni, where Prime Minister Manmohan Singh delivered lectures to crowded classrooms; and where economist Sir John Hicks held forth on consumer demand theory.

Set up in 1949, the D-School has remained a class apart—the finest training ground for economists in the country. B.L. Pandit, a former student and now the officiating head of the department of economics, says, "The quality of the programme and the work culture hasn't changed. Research is ongoing, reading lists are kept up-to-date and professors have the freedom to design classes on their own." The D-School also has its own research wing in the Centre for Development Research, funded by the government and Ford Foundation. But what really keeps it ticking is a faculty with impeccable credentials and active postgraduate students. "Many students join organisations like the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund with big pay packets, but after a few years, come back wanting to challenge themselves," says Pandit. What continues to stand out though is the D-School's contribution to fields even outside of economics through a list of prestigious names that includes sociologists like Andre Beteille and geographers like George Kuriyan.

by Deepika Khatri

"I refused a position at the D-School as I was asked to spend more time in the classroom than in the coffee house."

RAMACHANDRA GUNA, HISTORIAN AND D-SCHOOL ALUMNUS